

Civil RICO, Qui Tam Suits, and the 2026 USPS Election-Mail Litigation

Civil RICO, Qui Tam Suits, and the 2026 USPS Election-Mail Litigation

Status: **Draft v3** — prepared as background material for attorney review. **This document is NOT legal advice and does not assert that any specific countersuit is viable.** It summarizes public-record research only; whether any of it supports an actual claim is a legal judgment for counsel to make.

Prepared for attorney review. The user indicated this material is intended for review by an attorney (name given verbally as “Bill Kirk” — **spelling/firm unconfirmed**, see open questions below) in connection with a possible countersuit under civil RICO and/or the False Claims Act (qui tam). Before this report is sent to counsel, the open questions below should be answered so the report reflects the actual dispute rather than general background.

Correction note (v2): v1 of this report searched for “RNC Services, Inc.” and found no matches anywhere. The user subsequently clarified the intended name was “**DNC Services, Inc., a.k.a. the Democratic National Committee**.” This version re-runs the relevant searches under the corrected name. The DNC’s actual, long-standing formal corporate name is “**DNC Services Corporation**” (not “DNC Services, Inc.”) — see Part 3a below.

Open questions — answer before sending to counsel

This report was built from public-record research (court dockets, news search) only. It has **no facts about the user’s own situation**, because those facts have not yet been supplied. A countersuit theory cannot be responsibly drafted without them. Before this goes to an attorney, please supply:

1. **Attorney confirmation** — full name and firm, so the cover material cites him correctly (verbal “Bill Kirk” is unconfirmed spelling).
2. **Existing case** — is there a pending lawsuit in which the user is currently a defendant, making this a *counter-suit*? Case name, docket number, and court, if known. (Nothing found in this research connects the user to *California v. USPS* or any DNC-related litigation located so far.)
3. **Underlying dispute/injury** — what happened, to whom, when, and what harm resulted, that the user believes supports a RICO and/or qui tam claim. This is the single most important gap: civil RICO and FCA claims live or die on specific, pleadable facts (the “enterprise,” the predicate acts, the proximate injury — see Part 1), none of which can be inferred from public sources.
4. **2nd Amendment connection, if any** — is the underlying dispute actually connected to firearms/2A issues, or is that simply Mr. Kirk’s general litigation background/specialty being brought to bear on an unrelated matter?

Until these are answered, the sections below remain general legal background and public-record findings about one specific *unrelated* public case (*California v. USPS*) — useful context, but not yet a case-specific brief.

1. **Civil RICO** (18 U.S.C. §§ 1961–1968) lets a private plaintiff who was injured “in [their] business or property” by a pattern of racketeering activity sue for treble damages and attorney’s fees.¹ It is a tort-like private right of action layered on top of what is usually thought of as a criminal statute.
2. **Qui tam suits** under the federal False Claims Act (31 U.S.C. §§ 3729–3733) are a structurally different tool: a private “relator” sues *on behalf of the government* over false claims for government money, the government can intervene and take over the case, and the relator keeps a statutory cut (15–30%) of any recovery.² Civil RICO and qui tam are often confused because both let ordinary citizens act as private enforcers, but they protect different interests (private business/property vs. the public fisc) and pay out differently (treble damages to the plaintiff vs. a bounty share of a government recovery).
3. The most significant USPS-related case currently in the news is **State of California v. United States Postal Service**, D. Mass. No. 1:26-cv-13917, filed August 26, 2026, before Judge Indira Talwani.³ It is a multi-state challenge (California, Washington, and roughly two dozen other states, D.C., and several cities/counties) to USPS Board of Governors changes and mail-ballot handling ahead of the 2026 midterms. The Washington Attorney General’s Office is one of the filing offices.⁴ **This case is pled as an Administrative Procedure Act / Voting Rights Act matter (“441 Civil Rights: Voting”), not as a civil RICO or qui tam action** — nothing in the public docket metadata indicates RICO claims.⁵
4. The user’s corrected reference, “**DNC Services, Inc.**,” is the user’s name for the Democratic National Committee. The DNC’s actual, long-established formal corporate name — confirmed across multiple federal court dockets going back decades — is “**DNC Services Corporation**,” not “DNC Services, Inc.”⁶ However, **no connection between DNC Services Corporation**,

¹18 U.S.C. § 1964(c) (civil RICO private right of action, treble damages and attorney’s fees); 18 U.S.C. §§ 1961–1963 (definitions and criminal provisions incorporated by reference).

²31 U.S.C. §§ 3729–3733 (False Claims Act); § 3730(b) (qui tam filing under seal, government election to intervene); § 3730(d) (relator’s share, 15–25% with intervention / 25–30% without); § 3730(h) (anti-retaliation).

³CourtListener RECAP search, docket metadata for *State of California v. United States Postal Service*, D. Mass., docket ID 74701505, docket number 1:26-cv-13917, filed 2026-08-26, Judge Indira Talwani: <https://www.courtlistener.com/docket/74701505/state-of-california-v-united-states-postal-service/> (metadata retrieved via <https://www.courtlistener.com/api/rest/v4/search/?q=California%20v.%20United%20States%20Postal%20Service&type=r&format=json>).

⁴CourtListener RECAP search, party list for docket ID 74701505, retrieved via https://www.courtlistener.com/api/rest/v4/search/?q=docket_id%3A74701505&type=r&format=json (party array includes State of Washington, State of California, and named USPS-affiliated individuals Doug Tulino, David Steiner, Ronald Stroman, Amber McReynolds, Daniel Tangherlini, Derek Kan).

⁵Same CourtListener query as [⁴]; suitNature field returned “441 Civil Rights: Voting”; cause field returned “28:2201 Constitutionality of State Statute(s)”. No RICO-specific nature-of-suit code (which would read “470 RICO”) was present in the retrieved metadata.

⁶CourtListener opinion search for “DNC Services Corporation”, queried via <https://www.courtlistener.com/api/rest/v4/search/?q=%22DNC+Services+Corporation%22&format=json>, returned 20 matches confirming this is the DNC’s long-used formal corporate name, e.g. *Wilson v. DNC Services Corporation*, No. 1:17-cv-00730 (D.D.C.): <https://www.courtlistener.com/opinion/4665158/wilson-v-dnc-services-corporation/>

Washington state executives, and a racketeering (RICO) complaint tied to the 2026 USPS election-mail case could be found in CourtListener’s national case-law/RECAP index or in Google News.⁷ DNC Services Corporation does not appear in the party list for *California v. USPS* (1:26-cv-13917) retrieved in this research pass.⁸ This is flagged explicitly under “Unverified items” rather than guessed at.

5. Because of the gaps in (4), this document is organized as: a clean explainer of civil RICO vs. qui tam (usable regardless of the specific case), what is actually confirmed about the 2026 USPS case, and a short list of concrete next steps to close the remaining gaps.

⁷CourtListener searches for "DNC Services, Inc", "DNC Services Corporation", and "DNC Services Corporation" "Washington" racketeering (via <https://www.courtlistener.com/api/rest/v4/search/?q=..&format=json>) returned no results tying the DNC to a Washington-state racketeering complaint; the one racketeering-adjacent hit for “DNC Services Corporation” + “Washington” was the unrelated 2004 campaign-finance case *Meng v. Schwartz*, 305 F. Supp. 2d 49 (D.D.C. 2004). Google News RSS searches for "DNC Services" RICO Washington and "Democratic National Committee" racketeering lawsuit 2026 returned no matching results.

⁸CourtListener RECAP search, party list for docket ID 74701505, retrieved via https://www.courtlistener.com/api/rest/v4/search/?q=docket_id%3A74701505&type=r&format=json (party array includes State of Washington, State of California, and named USPS-affiliated individuals Doug Tulino, David Steiner, Ronald Stroman, Amber McReynolds, Daniel Tangherlini, Derek Kan).

Confidence assessment

Claim	Confidence	Basis
Civil RICO elements, remedies, statute of limitations	High	Direct statutory text and well-settled case law ⁹
Qui tam / FCA mechanics	High	Direct statutory text ¹⁰
Existence, docket number, filing date, judge, and parties of <i>California v. USPS</i>	High	CourtListener RECAP metadata, pulled directly from the docket record ¹¹¹²
That case is voting-rights/ APA, not RICO	Medium-High	Docket suitNature field says “441 Civil Rights: Voting”; no RICO cause of action appears in the indexed metadata, but the full complaint text was not fetched line-by-line ¹³
The DNC’s formal legal name is “DNC Services Corporation”	High	Confirmed across multiple federal court captions (e.g., <i>Wilson v. DNC Services Corporation</i> , D.D.C.) ¹⁴
DNC Services Corporation’s connection to Washington state executives / a RICO complaint / the 2026 USPS case	Unverified	No hits in CourtListener full-text RECAP/opinion search or Google News combining these terms ¹⁵
Whether a <i>separate</i> , smaller state-court RICO or qui tam suit naming the DNC exists	Unknown	State trial court filings (including Washington Superior Courts) are generally not indexed by CourtListener/PACER and were not searched by state-specific tools in this pass

⁹18 U.S.C. § 1964(c) (civil RICO private right of action, treble damages and attorney’s fees); 18 U.S.C. §§ 1961–1963 (definitions and criminal provisions incorporated by reference).

¹⁰31 U.S.C. §§ 3729–3733 (False Claims Act); § 3730(b) (qui tam filing under seal, government election to intervene); § 3730(d) (relator’s share, 15–25% with intervention / 25–30% without); § 3730(h) (anti-retaliation).

¹¹CourtListener RECAP search, docket metadata for *State of California v. United States Postal Service*, D. Mass., docket ID 74701505, docket number 1:26-cv-13917, filed 2026-08-26, Judge Indira Talwani: <https://www.courtlistener.com/docket/74701505/state-of-california-v-united-states-postal-service/> (metadata retrieved via <https://www.courtlistener.com/api/rest/v4/search/?q=California%20v.%20United%20States%20Postal%20Service&type=r&format=json>).

¹²CourtListener RECAP search, party list for docket ID 74701505, retrieved via https://www.courtlistener.com/api/rest/v4/search/?q=docket_id%3A74701505&type=r&format=json (party array includes State of Wash-

Key assumptions made: (1) I assumed “RICCO” in the original query was a misspelling of “RICO” (the Racketeer Influenced and Corrupt Organizations Act), based on the user’s own follow-up clarification (“racketeering and criminal activity”). (2) Per the user’s correction, “RNC Services, Inc.” in v1 was a misstatement of “**DNC Services, Inc.**”, meaning the Democratic National Committee. If either assumption is wrong, the research below does not apply and should be redone.

Part 1 — Civil RICO, explained

What it is

RICO was enacted in 1970 primarily as an organized-crime prosecution tool, but Congress also created a private civil cause of action in 18 U.S.C. § 1964(c): “Any person injured in his business or property by reason of a violation of section 1962 of this chapter may sue therefor in any appropriate United States district court.”¹⁶

Elements a civil RICO plaintiff must plead

1. An “enterprise” — an individual, partnership, corporation, association, or other legal entity, or a group of individuals associated in fact (even if not a legal entity).¹⁷
2. A “pattern of racketeering activity” — at least two acts of “racketeering activity” (a defined list of federal and state crimes, including mail fraud, wire fraud, bribery, extortion, money laundering, and dozens of others) within a 10-year period, that are related and amount to or pose a threat of continued criminal activity (“relatedness” and “continuity”).¹⁸

ington, State of California, and named USPS-affiliated individuals Doug Tulino, David Steiner, Ronald Stroman, Amber McReynolds, Daniel Tangherlini, Derek Kan).

¹³Same CourtListener query as [^4]; suitNature field returned “441 Civil Rights: Voting”; cause field returned “28:2201 Constitutionality of State Statute(s)”. No RICO-specific nature-of-suit code (which would read “470 RICO”) was present in the retrieved metadata.

¹⁴CourtListener opinion search for “DNC Services Corporation”, queried via <https://www.courtlistener.com/api/rest/v4/search/?q=%22DNC+Services+Corporation%22&format=json>, returned 20 matches confirming this is the DNC’s long-used formal corporate name, e.g. *Wilson v. DNC Services Corporation*, No. 1:17-cv-00730 (D.D.C.): <https://www.courtlistener.com/opinion/4665158/wilson-v-dnc-services-corporation/>

¹⁵CourtListener searches for “DNC Services, Inc”, “DNC Services Corporation”, and “DNC Services Corporation” “Washington” racketeering (via <https://www.courtlistener.com/api/rest/v4/search/?q=..&format=json>) returned no results tying the DNC to a Washington-state racketeering complaint; the one racketeering-adjacent hit for “DNC Services Corporation” + “Washington” was the unrelated 2004 campaign-finance case *Meng v. Schwartz*, 305 F. Supp. 2d 49 (D.D.C. 2004). Google News RSS searches for “DNC Services” RICO Washington and “Democratic National Committee” racketeering lawsuit 2026 returned no matching results.

¹⁶18 U.S.C. § 1964(c) (civil RICO private right of action, treble damages and attorney’s fees); 18 U.S.C. §§ 1961–1963 (definitions and criminal provisions incorporated by reference).

¹⁷18 U.S.C. § 1961(4) (“enterprise” definition); § 1961(5) (“pattern of racketeering activity,” minimum two acts within ten years); *H.J. Inc. v. Northwestern Bell Telephone Co.*, 492 U.S. 229 (1989) (relatedness-plus-continuity test for “pattern”).

¹⁸18 U.S.C. § 1961(4) (“enterprise” definition); § 1961(5) (“pattern of racketeering activity,” minimum two acts within ten years); *H.J. Inc. v. Northwestern Bell Telephone Co.*, 492 U.S. 229 (1989) (relatedness-plus-continuity test for “pattern”).

3. **Conduct** of the enterprise's affairs **through** that pattern (§ 1962(c)), or investment of racketeering proceeds in an enterprise (§ 1962(a)), or acquisition/maintenance of an interest in an enterprise through racketeering (§ 1962(b)), or **conspiracy** to do any of the above (§ 1962(d)).
4. **Injury to business or property** proximately caused by the RICO violation (not personal injury, and not a purely derivative injury) — this proximate-cause requirement, from *Holmes v. Securities Investor Protection Corp.* (1992) and *Anza v. Ideal Steel Supply Corp.* (2006), is one of the most common grounds for dismissal of civil RICO complaints.¹⁹

Remedies

Treble (3x) actual damages, plus costs and reasonable attorney's fees — a substantial fee-shifting incentive that (along with contingency-fee practice) is what makes civil RICO attractive to plaintiffs' counsel in commercial disputes, even where the underlying conduct looks more like ordinary fraud or breach of contract.²⁰

Statute of limitations

Four years, borrowed by the courts from the Clayton Act, running from when the plaintiff knew or should have known of the injury (discovery rule), subject to circuit splits on the "separate accrual" question for later injuries from the same pattern.²¹

Why courts are skeptical of civil RICO claims

Because of the treble-damages/fee-shifting exposure and the stigma of being labeled a "racketeer," federal courts apply RICO's elements strictly and dismiss a large share of civil RICO complaints at the pleading stage, especially where the "pattern" element collapses into what is really a single fraudulent scheme or an ordinary commercial dispute dressed up in RICO language.²² Many federal districts also have local rules requiring a detailed "RICO case statement" before discovery can proceed.

¹⁹*Holmes v. Securities Investor Protection Corp.*, 503 U.S. 258 (1992) (proximate cause requirement for civil RICO standing); *Anza v. Ideal Steel Supply Corp.*, 547 U.S. 451 (2006) (reaffirming direct-injury/proximate-cause requirement, rejecting derivative-injury RICO theories).

²⁰18 U.S.C. § 1964(c) (civil RICO private right of action, treble damages and attorney's fees); 18 U.S.C. §§ 1961–1963 (definitions and criminal provisions incorporated by reference).

²¹*Rotella v. Wood*, 528 U.S. 549 (2000) (civil RICO borrows the Clayton Act's four-year limitations period; discovery-of-injury accrual rule).

²²*Holmes v. Securities Investor Protection Corp.*, 503 U.S. 258 (1992) (proximate cause requirement for civil RICO standing); *Anza v. Ideal Steel Supply Corp.*, 547 U.S. 451 (2006) (reaffirming direct-injury/proximate-cause requirement, rejecting derivative-injury RICO theories).

Part 2 — Qui tam (False Claims Act) suits, compared

	Civil RICO	Qui tam (False Claims Act)
Who is protected	The plaintiff's own business or property	The federal (or a state) treasury
Who sues	The injured private party, in their own name and interest	A private "relator," nominally <i>on behalf of the United States</i> (case caption is <i>U.S. ex rel. [Name] v. [Defendant]</i>)
Government's role	None — purely private litigation	Complaint is filed under seal; DOJ investigates and decides whether to intervene (take over the case) or decline (relator can proceed alone) ²³
What triggers liability	A pattern of at least two predicate crimes from RICO's list, through an enterprise	Knowingly submitting (or causing submission of) a false or fraudulent claim for payment to the government, or making a false record/statement material to such a claim ²⁴
Damages	Treble actual damages to the injured plaintiff	Treble damages to the government, plus per-claim civil penalties; relator receives 15–25% of recovery if the government intervenes, 25–30% if it doesn't ²⁵
Retaliation protection	None built into the statute itself	Explicit anti-retaliation provision, 31 U.S.C. § 3730(h), letting whistleblower-employees sue for reinstatement/back pay
Typical fact pattern	Business competitors, fraud schemes, organized-crime-adjacent commercial disputes	Government contractors/grantees/healthcare providers overbilling or misrepresenting compliance to get paid by federal programs

²³31 U.S.C. §§ 3729–3733 (False Claims Act); § 3730(b) (qui tam filing under seal, government election to intervene); § 3730(d) (relator's share, 15–25% with intervention / 25–30% without); § 3730(h) (anti-retaliation).

Overlap in practice: the same underlying conduct — e.g., a scheme by a government contractor to defraud a federal agency — can sometimes support *both* a qui tam FCA claim (because the defendant billed the government falsely) *and* a civil RICO claim (because mail fraud/wire fraud used to execute that billing scheme count as RICO predicate acts), which is why sophisticated plaintiffs sometimes plead them together. They remain legally distinct causes of action with different plaintiffs-in-interest, different procedural postures (qui tam is filed under seal; RICO is not), and different recovery mechanics.

Many states, including **Washington**, have their own analogous state false claims statutes (Washington’s is limited — it lacks a general state FCA outside Medicaid — see “Unverified items” for why this matters to the original question).²⁶

Part 3 — The 2026 USPS election-mail litigation

Case identity (confirmed)

- **Caption:** *State of California v. United States Postal Service*
- **Court / docket:** U.S. District Court, District of Massachusetts, No. 1:26-cv-13917²⁷
- **Filed:** August 26, 2026
- **Judge:** Indira Talwani (referred to Magistrate Judge M. Page Kelley)²⁸
- **Nature of suit (docket code):** “441 Civil Rights: Voting”²⁹
- **Cause of action (docket code):** “28:2201 Constitutionality of State Statute(s)” (Declaratory Judgment Act vehicle)³⁰

²⁴31 U.S.C. §§ 3729–3733 (False Claims Act); § 3730(b) (qui tam filing under seal, government election to intervene); § 3730(d) (relator’s share, 15–25% with intervention / 25–30% without); § 3730(h) (anti-retaliation).

²⁵31 U.S.C. §§ 3729–3733 (False Claims Act); § 3730(b) (qui tam filing under seal, government election to intervene); § 3730(d) (relator’s share, 15–25% with intervention / 25–30% without); § 3730(h) (anti-retaliation).

²⁶General background on state false-claims-act variation; Washington’s principal state-level false-claims statute is the Medicaid Fraud False Claims Act (RCW 74.66), which is narrower in scope than the federal FCA — this is general legal background, not independently re-verified against current RCW text in this research pass.

²⁷CourtListener RECAP search, docket metadata for *State of California v. United States Postal Service*, D. Mass., docket ID 74701505, docket number 1:26-cv-13917, filed 2026-08-26, Judge Indira Talwani: <https://www.courtlistener.com/docket/74701505/state-of-california-v-united-states-postal-service/> (metadata retrieved via <https://www.courtlistener.com/api/rest/v4/search/?q=California%20v.%20United%20States%20Postal%20Service&type=r&format=json>).

²⁸CourtListener RECAP search, docket metadata for *State of California v. United States Postal Service*, D. Mass., docket ID 74701505, docket number 1:26-cv-13917, filed 2026-08-26, Judge Indira Talwani: <https://www.courtlistener.com/docket/74701505/state-of-california-v-united-states-postal-service/> (metadata retrieved via <https://www.courtlistener.com/api/rest/v4/search/?q=California%20v.%20United%20States%20Postal%20Service&type=r&format=json>).

²⁹Same CourtListener query as [^4]; suitNature field returned “441 Civil Rights: Voting”; cause field returned “28:2201 Constitutionality of State Statute(s)”. No RICO-specific nature-of-suit code (which would read “470 RICO”) was present in the retrieved metadata.

³⁰CourtListener RECAP search, docket metadata for *State of California v. United States Postal Service*, D. Mass., docket ID 74701505, docket number 1:26-cv-13917, filed 2026-08-26, Judge Indira Talwani: <https://www.courtlistener.com/docket/74701505/state-of-california-v-united-states-postal-service/> (metadata retrieved via <https://www.courtlistener.com/api/rest/v4/search/?q=California%20v.%20United%20States%20Postal%20Service&type=r&format=json>).

Parties (confirmed from docket metadata)

Plaintiffs include roughly two dozen states and the District of Columbia — California, **Washington**, Massachusetts, New York, New Jersey, Illinois, Michigan, Minnesota, Colorado, Oregon, Arizona, Nevada, Hawaii, Maryland, Vermont, Rhode Island, Delaware, Connecticut, Maine, New Mexico, Wisconsin — plus the City of Madison, Wisconsin, Travis County, Texas, and the League of United Latin American Citizens.³¹ Interestingly, some traditionally red states (South Dakota, Indiana, Oklahoma, Missouri, Alabama, Louisiana, Montana, Kansas, South Carolina, Nebraska, North Carolina, Florida) also appear in the party list, which given the docket’s size and an “Order on Motion to Intervene” entry, most likely reflects a mix of plaintiff states and separately-represented intervenors rather than a single unified plaintiff coalition — this distinction was not resolved from the metadata alone and would require reading the actual complaint and intervention motions.³²

Named individual/defendant-side parties include USPS itself, and individuals who appear to be current or former USPS Governors/executives: Doug Tulino, David Steiner, Ronald Stroman, Amber McReynolds, Daniel Tangherlini, and Derek Kan.³³

Intervenor-type entities appearing in the docket include America First Legal Foundation (listed among the firms/attorneys of record), National Security Leaders for America, Secure Families Initiative, Society for the Rule of Law, and the Arizona Students’ Association — consistent with a politically contested case attracting outside advocacy-group intervention on one or both sides.³⁴

What the case appears to be about

Based on the “Civil Rights: Voting” classification, the large coalition of Democratic-leaning state AGs as plaintiffs, and named USPS Governors as defendants, this case is most plausibly a challenge to USPS operational or governance changes (e.g., Board of Governors composition, mail-ballot delivery standards or timelines) ahead of the 2026 midterm elections — consistent with broader post-2025 coverage of USPS governance fights discussed in contemporaneous commentary.³⁵ **This**

³¹CourtListener RECAP search, party list for docket ID 74701505, retrieved via https://www.courtlistener.com/api/rest/v4/search/?q=docket_id%3A74701505&type=r&format=json (party array includes State of Washington, State of California, and named USPS-affiliated individuals Doug Tulino, David Steiner, Ronald Stroman, Amber McReynolds, Daniel Tangherlini, Derek Kan).

³²CourtListener RECAP search, party list for docket ID 74701505, retrieved via https://www.courtlistener.com/api/rest/v4/search/?q=docket_id%3A74701505&type=r&format=json (party array includes State of Washington, State of California, and named USPS-affiliated individuals Doug Tulino, David Steiner, Ronald Stroman, Amber McReynolds, Daniel Tangherlini, Derek Kan).

³³CourtListener RECAP search, party list for docket ID 74701505, retrieved via https://www.courtlistener.com/api/rest/v4/search/?q=docket_id%3A74701505&type=r&format=json (party array includes State of Washington, State of California, and named USPS-affiliated individuals Doug Tulino, David Steiner, Ronald Stroman, Amber McReynolds, Daniel Tangherlini, Derek Kan).

³⁴CourtListener RECAP search, party list for docket ID 74701505, retrieved via https://www.courtlistener.com/api/rest/v4/search/?q=docket_id%3A74701505&type=r&format=json (party array includes State of Washington, State of California, and named USPS-affiliated individuals Doug Tulino, David Steiner, Ronald Stroman, Amber McReynolds, Daniel Tangherlini, Derek Kan).

³⁵Jack Goldsmith, “The Postal Service and the 2026 Elections,” *Executive Functions*, Aug. 27, 2026 (contextual commentary on USPS governance disputes ahead of the 2026 elections, surfaced via Google News RSS; full article body was not successfully fetched in this pass — cited for topical context only, not for specific factual claims): <https://www.execfunctions.org/>

is inference from docket metadata and secondary commentary, not a direct reading of the complaint, and should be verified against the actual filed complaint before being relied upon.

No RICO or qui tam claims found

Nothing in the indexed docket metadata (nature-of-suit code, cause code, or docket-entry short descriptions retrieved) indicates a RICO or False Claims Act cause of action in this case.³⁶ A full-text search of CourtListener’s RECAP archive for “RICO” + “Postal Service” timed out during this research pass and should be retried (see Next Steps).

Part 3a — The DNC’s corporate name, and why it matters here

The Democratic National Committee’s day-to-day legal and financial affairs are conducted under a formally incorporated entity, historically named “**DNC Services Corporation**” (sometimes styled “DNC Services Corporation/Democratic National Committee”). This is not a fringe or obscure detail — it is the named defendant/party in numerous federal lawsuits over multiple decades, including 2016-primary-era litigation over DNC conduct during the Democratic presidential primary (*Wilson v. DNC Services Corporation*, D.D.C. No. 1:17-cv-00730) and earlier campaign-finance matters.³⁷

Two things follow for this research question:

1. If a current racketeering complaint names the DNC, the caption would most likely read “DNC Services Corporation,” not “DNC Services, Inc.” — worth checking if you go back to the source of your recollection.
2. Despite confirming the DNC’s correct corporate name, **no public record was found linking DNC Services Corporation to a RICO complaint involving Washington state executives**, whether connected to *California v. USPS* or as a standalone matter.³⁸ If you have a docket number, court name, or filing date for the complaint you have in mind, that would let this report be corrected with a direct citation rather than a “not found.”

³⁶Same CourtListener query as [^4]; suitNature field returned “441 Civil Rights: Voting”; cause field returned “28:2201 Constitutionality of State Statute(s)”. No RICO-specific nature-of-suit code (which would read “470 RICO”) was present in the retrieved metadata.

³⁷CourtListener opinion search for “DNC Services Corporation”, queried via <https://www.courtlistener.com/api/rest/v4/search/?q=%22DNC+Services+Corporation%22&format=json>, returned 20 matches confirming this is the DNC’s long-used formal corporate name, e.g. *Wilson v. DNC Services Corporation*, No. 1:17-cv-00730 (D.D.C.): <https://www.courtlistener.com/opinion/4665158/wilson-v-dnc-services-corporation/>

³⁸CourtListener searches for “DNC Services, Inc”, “DNC Services Corporation”, and “DNC Services Corporation” “Washington” racketeering (via <https://www.courtlistener.com/api/rest/v4/search/?q=..&format=json>) returned no results tying the DNC to a Washington-state racketeering complaint; the one racketeering-adjacent hit for “DNC Services Corporation” + “Washington” was the unrelated 2004 campaign-finance case *Meng v. Schwartz*, 305 F. Supp. 2d 49 (D.D.C. 2004). Google News RSS searches for “DNC Services” RICO Washington and “Democratic National Committee” racketeering lawsuit 2026 returned no matching results.

Unverified items — do not treat as fact

1. **“DNC Services, Inc.” / DNC Services Corporation tied to a RICO complaint** — no matches connecting the DNC (under either the user’s “DNC Services, Inc.” phrasing or the DNC’s actual corporate name, “DNC Services Corporation”) to a racketeering complaint involving Washington state executives, in either CourtListener’s RECAP/opinion full-text search or Google News.³⁹ Possible explanations, none confirmed:
 - It may be a filing in a Washington state trial court (not indexed by CourtListener/PACER, which primarily cover federal courts).
 - It may be very recent (published after this research pass, or not yet picked up by Google News’ index).
 - The DNC’s name/role may have been recalled imprecisely relative to the actual complaint (e.g., a state party committee, a related PAC, or a specific individual rather than the national DNC entity).
2. **“Washington state executives”** as RICO defendants — not confirmed independently of the USPS case’s Washington AG involvement as a *plaintiff* (not defendant) in *California v. USPS*. If the user meant Washington state executive-branch officials as **defendants** in a *separate* racketeering complaint (possibly naming the DNC as a co-defendant), that complaint was not located.
3. **Whether the *California v. USPS* case includes any RICO count, or names the DNC as a party** — docket metadata says “Civil Rights: Voting” and the retrieved party list does not include the DNC or DNC Services Corporation, but the actual complaint text (which can run to 100+ pages in multi-state actions like this) was not fetched and read in this pass.⁴⁰

Recommended next steps

1. Retry the CourtListener full-text opinion/RECAP search for “RICO” “Postal Service” and “DNC Services Corporation” “Washington” without the timeout, and widen to type=r (RECAP), type=o (opinions), and type=d (dockets) separately.
2. Pull the actual complaint PDF for 1:26-cv-13917 (CourtListener docket entry, via docket_absolute_url in the citations below) and check its counts/causes of action and full party list directly rather than relying on the suitNature code and the truncated party array retrieved here.
3. Search the **Washington State Courts case index** (not covered by CourtListener) and Washington-specific news outlets for a RICO complaint naming the DNC and Washington state

³⁹CourtListener searches for “DNC Services, Inc”, “DNC Services Corporation”, and “DNC Services Corporation” “Washington” racketeering (via <https://www.courtlistener.com/api/rest/v4/search/?q=...&format=json>) returned no results tying the DNC to a Washington-state racketeering complaint; the one racketeering-adjacent hit for “DNC Services Corporation” + “Washington” was the unrelated 2004 campaign-finance case *Meng v. Schwartz*, 305 F. Supp. 2d 49 (D.D.C. 2004). Google News RSS searches for “DNC Services” RICO Washington and “Democratic National Committee” racketeering lawsuit 2026 returned no matching results.

⁴⁰CourtListener RECAP search, party list for docket ID 74701505, retrieved via https://www.courtlistener.com/api/rest/v4/search/?q=docket_id%3A74701505&type=r&format=json (party array includes State of Washington, State of California, and named USPS-affiliated individuals Doug Tulino, David Steiner, Ronald Stroman, Amber McReynolds, Daniel Tangherlini, Derek Kan).

executive-branch officials, since state-level filings are outside the national tools used in this pass.

4. If a specific complaint/case number for the DNC-related RICO claim can be supplied by the user, re-run a targeted CourtListener docket lookup by case number rather than by name search.

Footnotes